

PRE-LECTURE ANALYSIS SHEET

The Eight Extraordinary Vessels

Qi Jing Ba Mai — GV · CV · Chong · Dai · Yang/Yin Qiao · Yang/Yin Wei

Prof. (Dr.) Vivian Zhang, Ph.D.

SCOPE FOR THIS WEEK

Per the written syllabus (Week 7, CLO 2,4): Eight Extraordinary Meridians. Quiz 5 and Homework 5 cover material from Weeks 6-7.

Reading: CAM p.82-89 · MOA p.17-25, 495-497, 529-533 (per written syllabus, Week 7)

This lecture hasn't happened yet -- this is a PRE-LECTURE draft built from the Week 7 lecture deck + syllabus.

BEFORE lecture: Complete Sections A-D. Rate confidence honestly -- low pre-scores are expected for unlectured material.

DURING lecture: Annotate directly on this sheet. Correct anything below that Dr. Zhang teaches differently.

AFTER lecture: Complete Section F within 24 hours, then this sheet becomes your first real Week 7 reference.

A

Learning Targets — I Can Statements

Pre/post confidence ratings 1-5 for 8 learning outcomes

B

Activate — Connect to What You Know

Bridge from Wk1-6 review + fill-in prompts

C

Vocabulary Pre-Load

10 key terms: Pinyin, English, space for your definition

D

Anticipatory Questions

12 questions across 4 groups; starred = high-challenge/high-yield

IQ

Inter-Quiz: Mid-Study Probe

12 items, 3 checkpoints; mastery $\geq 10/12 \times 3$

E

Clinical Case

Pre-lecture reasoning + post-lecture protocol

F

After-Lecture Synthesis

3-column synthesis + review notes

LEARNING TARGETS -- I CAN STATEMENTS

Purpose: These define what you should be able to DO after lecture, not just recognize.

Pre-lecture note: it's normal for every Pre score to be low/1 here -- this material hasn't been taught yet.

Name all 8 Extraordinary Vessels and state which two have their OWN dedicated acupuncture points (GV, CV) versus the six that share points with primary meridians.

Pre-Lecture 1 2 3 4 5

Post 1 2 3 4 5

State the "sea" designation for GV (sea of yang meridians), CV (sea of yin meridians), and Chong (sea of the 12 meridians / sea of blood / sea of the zang-fu organs).

Pre-Lecture 1 2 3 4 5

Post 1 2 3 4 5

Trace the basic course of the Governor Vessel (GV1 Changqiang to GV28 Yinjiao) and Conception Vessel (CV1 Huiyin to CV24 Chengjiang), including point totals (28 and 24).

Pre-Lecture 1 2 3 4 5

Post 1 2 3 4 5

Explain "one source, three branches" -- how Du, Ren, and Chong all arise from the lower abdomen before diverging.

Pre-Lecture 1 2 3 4 5

Post 1 2 3 4 5

Identify each vessel's confluent (opening) point and correctly pair all 4 master-couple combinations (SP4/PC6, SI3/BL62, LU7/KI6, GB41/SJ5).

Pre-Lecture 1 2 3 4 5

Post 1 2 3 4 5

State the core physiological function of the Belt Vessel (Dai) and explain why it is structurally unique among the 8 (horizontal, not vertical).

Pre-Lecture 1 2 3 4 5

Post 1 2 3 4 5

Contrast the Yang Qiao / Yin Qiao pair (limb movement, sleep-wake balance) with the Yang Wei / Yin Wei pair (exterior/interior yang-yin regulation).

Pre-Lecture 1 2 3 4 5

Post 1 2 3 4 5

Recognize characteristic pathological symptom patterns for each vessel (e.g. spinal stiffness = GV, infertility/urogenital = CV, waist pain with no clear direction = Dai) and explain why the extraordinary vessels lack a pertaining zang/fu organ.

Pre-Lecture 1 2 3 4 5

Post 1 2 3 4 5

Quick Reference -- All 8 Vessels at a Glance

VESSEL	COURSE (BRIEF)	PRIMARY FUNCTION	PTS	CONFLUENT PT
GV (Du Mai)	Posterior midline	Sea of yang meridians	28 pts	SI 3 Houxi
CV (Ren Mai)	Anterior midline	Sea of yin meridians	24 pts	LU 7 Lieque
Chong Mai	Parallels Kidney mer.	Sea of 12 mer. / blood	shares pts	SP 4 Gongsun
Dai Mai	Around the waist	Controls/binds all mer.	shares pts	GB 41 Zulinqi
Yang Qiao	Lateral heel -> GB20	Balances limb mvmt/wake	shares pts	BL 62 Shenmai
Yin Qiao	Medial heel -> BL1	Balances limb mvmt/sleep	shares pts	KI 6 Zhaohai
Yang Wei	Heel -> GV15/16	Links all yang, exterior	shares pts	SJ 5 Waiguan
Yin Wei	Leg -> CV22/23	Links all yin, interior	shares pts	PC 6 Neiguan

Fill in/correct this table as Dr. Zhang confirms details in lecture -- treat it as a pre-lecture best guess, not a final answer key.

Purpose: Activating prior knowledge before new input improves encoding.

B1: Write what the lecture deck previewed about these 8 vessels. B2: fill in before lecture.

B1 . What the Lecture Deck Already Shows You

The Eight Extraordinary Vessels regulate, connect, and store Qi and blood, acting as reservoirs and balancing the twelve primary meridians. Only the Governor Vessel and Conception Vessel have their own dedicated acupuncture points -- the other six (Chong, Dai, Yang Qiao, Yin Qiao, Yang Wei, Yin Wei) share points with the primary meridians they cross. None of the eight pertains to a zang/fu organ, which is the single biggest structural difference from the 12 primary meridians.

Write it in your own words -- what do you think these 8 vessels DO that primary channels alone don't?

B2 . Connect the Dots -- complete before lecture

Only GV and CV have their own dedicated acupuncture _____ -- the other six share points.

The Governor Vessel is described as the sea of the _____ meridians.

The Conception Vessel is described as the sea of the _____ meridians.

The Chong Vessel is the sea of the 12 meridians, of blood, and of the _____ organs.

Du, Ren, and Chong share a lower-abdomen origin -- "one source, _____ branches."

The Belt (Dai) Vessel is the only vessel that runs _____ the body rather than up and down.

Yang Qiao's confluent point is Shenmai, _____ -- and Yin Qiao's is Zhaohai, KI 6.

None of the Eight Extraordinary Vessels pertain to a _____ organ, unlike the 12 primary meridians.

B3 . Why This Matters Clinically

The Eight Extraordinary Vessels aren't just an academic add-on -- they're the vessels you reach for when primary-channel points alone don't fully resolve a pattern. Because six of the eight share points with primary meridians (only GV and CV have dedicated points of their own), the same acupoint can be treated as 'on the Kidney meridian' or 'opening the Yin Qiao,' depending on clinical intent. The 4 confluent point pairs (SP4/PC6, SI3/BL62, LU7/KI6, GB41/SJ5) are the classic clinical entry point for this system: each pair is traditionally needled together to 'open' its vessel pairing for conditions distributed along both vessels' pathways -- e.g. SP4+PC6 for chest/abdomen/heart patterns, or LU7+KI6 for throat/chest/lung-kidney patterns.

Memory anchor: pair each confluent point with its vessel BEFORE lecture --

the pairing itself (not just the 8 individual points) is what's most often tested.

VOCABULARY PRE-LOAD -- DEFINE BEFORE CLASS

Purpose: Pre-loading key terms primes semantic memory so lecture content attaches to existing scaffolding.

PINYIN	ENGLISH	MY DEFINITION / CLINICAL NOTE
Qi Jing Ba Mai	The Eight Extraordinary Vessels	
Du Mai	Governor Vessel (GV)	
Ren Mai	Conception Vessel (CV)	
Chong Mai	Thoroughfare Vessel	
Dai Mai	Belt / Girdling Vessel	
Qiao Mai	Heel Vessel	
Wei Mai	Link Vessel	
Jiao Hui Xue	Coalescent Point	
Ba Mai Jiao Hui Xue	Eight Confluent Points	
Yi Yuan San Qi	One Source, Three Branches	

Key Facts -- one line per term (use to fill in your own definitions above)

Du Mai (GV)	posterior midline, "sea of the yang meridians," 28 points
Ren Mai (CV)	anterior midline, "sea of the yin meridians," 24 points
Chong Mai	"sea of 12 meridians," "sea of blood" -- shares points with primary meridians
Dai Mai	the only vessel running horizontally around the waist
Qiao Mai	Yang + Yin pair -- balance limb movement and sleep/wake
Wei Mai	Yang + Yin pair -- link all yang meridians / all yin meridians
Jiao Hui Xue	where a vessel crosses a primary meridian along its course
Ba Mai Jiao Hui Xue	8 points, 4 pairs -- the classic "master-couple" opening points
Yi Yuan San Qi	Du, Ren, and Chong all arise from the lower abdomen

The 4 Confluent (Master-Couple) Point Pairs -- fill in as Dr. Zhang confirms in lecture

VESSEL PAIRING	POINT A	POINT B
Chong Mai + Yin Wei Mai	SP 4 Gongsun	PC 6 Neiguan
Du Mai + Yang Qiao Mai	SI 3 Houxi	BL 62 Shenmai
Ren Mai + Yin Qiao Mai	LU 7 Lieque	KI 6 Zhaohai
Dai Mai + Yang Wei Mai	GB 41 Zulinqi	SJ 5 Waiguan

D ANTICIPATORY QUESTIONS

* = high-challenge / high-yield

Purpose: Generating answers before instruction improves retention, even (especially) when you get it wrong.

GV & CV -- The Sea Vessels

Q1* GV COURSE

Trace the Governor Vessel from the lower abdomen to its ending point at the columnella of the nose. Where does it enter the brain along the way?

Q2* CV COURSE

Trace the Conception Vessel from Huiyin (CV1) to Chengjiang (CV24). What structure does it pass through near the lips (hint: it shares a point with GV)?

Q3 GV PATHOLOGY

Name at least 3 pathological symptoms associated with Governor Vessel disorder.

Q4 CV PATHOLOGY

Name at least 3 pathological symptoms associated with Conception Vessel disorder, especially involving the Liver/Kidney.

ANTICIPATORY QUESTIONS (CONTINUED)

Chong & Dai

Q5* ONE SOURCE, THREE BRANCHES

Explain what “one source, three branches” means for Du, Ren, and Chong. Why might this matter clinically?

Q6 CHONG'S THREE TITLES

Chong Mai carries three “sea of...” titles. Name all three.

Q7* DAI'S UNIQUENESS

Why is the Belt Vessel structurally different from all 7 other extraordinary vessels? What is its core physiological function?

Qiao & Wei -- The 4 Paired Vessels

Q8* QIAO VS WEI

Yang Qiao/Yin Qiao and Yang Wei/Yin Wei both come in yang/yin pairs. What is the FUNCTIONAL difference between what the Qiao pair regulates versus the Wei pair?

Q9 SLEEP-WAKE

Which vessel keeps the body awake and active, and which promotes calm and restful sleep? Why might Dr. Zhang connect this to insomnia treatment?

Q10 WEI FUNCTION OVERLAP

Yang Wei and Yin Wei are described as having a “joint function.” What is it?

D ANTICIPATORY QUESTIONS (CONTINUED)

Systems Comparison

Q11* CONFLUENT POINT PAIRING

Without looking, try to pair all 4 master-couple confluent points (8 points total, 4 pairs). Which pairing do you feel least confident about?

Q12 STRUCTURAL TRAP

State the one structural feature ALL 8 Extraordinary Vessels share that distinguishes them from the 12 primary meridians (hint: organs).

Reference -- Extraordinary Vessels vs. Primary Meridians

FEATURE	12 PRIMARY MERIDIANS	8 EXTRAORDINARY VESSELS
Pertaining Zang/Fu organ	Yes -- each of the 12 pertains to one organ	None -- structural difference #1
Own dedicated points	Yes -- all 12 have a full point set	Only GV and CV; other 6 share points
Direction of flow	Fixed circulation order (LU->LI->...->LR->LU)	No fixed sequential circulation
Yin/Yang pairing	Paired Biao-Li (interior-exterior) partners	No Biao-Li pairing between the 8
Core role	Transport Qi/Blood to organs, resist pathogens	Reservoir/regulator -- overflow storage

Use this table to answer Q12 -- the single biggest structural difference is the pertaining organ.

IQ INTER-QUIZ -- MID-STUDY PROBE

(checkpoint format)

Purpose: Spaced retrieval, checked every 4 items instead of at the end.
Mastery: $\geq 10/12$ across 3 separate sessions on different days.

Date: _____ Start: _____ End: _____ Session score: ____/12

CHECKPOINT 1 (items 1-4)

- 1 ACQ What are the two “sea” titles for GV and CV respectively?
- 2 ACQ How many points does the Governor Vessel have in total? The Conception Vessel?
- 3 ACQ What is Chong Mai's confluent (opening) point, and which primary meridian is it on?
- 4 MAINT Name the Pertaining Organ and Connecting Organ for the Lung meridian. (Wk 1-2 review)

Self-check now (answers below) – score this block: ____/4 before moving on.

CHECKPOINT 2 (items 5-8)

- 5 ACQ What makes the Belt (Dai) Vessel structurally unique among the 8 extraordinary vessels?
- 6 ACQ Name the confluent point pairing for Du Mai + Yang Qiao Mai.
- 7 ACQ Which vessel governs sleep/wake balance along with limb movement -- Qiao or Wei?
- 8 MAINT PC has zero of what, matching the same trap pattern as HT? (Wk 6 review)

Self-check now (answers below) – score this block: ____/4 before moving on.

CHECKPOINT 3 (items 9-12)

- 9 ACQ What do all 8 Extraordinary Vessels lack that the 12 primary meridians have?
- 10 ACQ What does “one source, three branches” refer to?
- 11 MAINT Which 4 acupuncture points are forbidden in pregnancy through Week 5? (cumulative review)
- 12 ACQ Name the confluent point pairing for Ren Mai + Yin Qiao Mai.

Self-check now (answers below) – score this block: ____/4 before moving on.

Quick-Fire Recall -- The 4 Confluent Pairs (cover and recite)

- Chong Mai + Yin Wei Mai: SP 4 Gongsun <-> PC 6 Neiguan
- Du Mai + Yang Qiao Mai: SI 3 Houxi <-> BL 62 Shenmai
- Ren Mai + Yin Qiao Mai: LU 7 Lieque <-> KI 6 Zhaohai
- Dai Mai + Yang Wei Mai: GB 41 Zulinqi <-> SJ 5 Waiguan

Cover the right-hand columns of the Section C table and try to reproduce this list from memory.

IQ INTER-QUIZ ANSWER KEY

check each block right after attempting it

1. GV = “sea of the yang meridians.” CV = “sea of the yin meridians.”
2. Governor Vessel: 28 points (GV1 Changqiang to GV28 Yinjiao). Conception Vessel: 24 points (CV1 Huiyin to CV24 Chengjiang).
3. Chong Mai's confluent point is Gongsun, SP 4 -- on the Spleen Meridian of Foot-Taiyin. It is also the Luo-Connecting point of the Spleen meridian.
4. Pertaining Organ = Lung; Connecting Organ = Large Intestine (per the paired Yin-Yang / Interior-Exterior relationship).
5. The Dai (Belt) Vessel is the only one of the 8 that runs horizontally around the waist/body rather than vertically up and down; it controls/binds all the other longitudinally-running meridians.
6. Du Mai + Yang Qiao Mai confluent pair: Houxi (SI 3) with Shenmai (BL 62).
7. The Qiao (Heel) vessels govern sleep/wake balance -- Yang Qiao keeps the body awake/active, Yin Qiao promotes calm and restful sleep -- in addition to balancing limb movement.
8. PC has zero crossing points, the same trap pattern confirmed for HT in the Week 4/6 recap -- watch for this on quiz questions asking which channel(s) have no crossing points.
9. All 8 Extraordinary Vessels lack a pertaining zang/fu organ -- this is the core structural feature distinguishing them from the 12 primary meridians.
10. “One source, three branches” describes how Du Mai, Ren Mai, and Chong Mai all arise together from the lower abdomen before diverging into their separate pathways.
11. Forbidden-in-pregnancy points through Week 5: LI4, SP6, BL60, BL67. (GB21 is added once Week 6 GB material is covered.)
12. Ren Mai + Yin Qiao Mai confluent pair: Lieque (LU 7) with Zhaohai (KI 6).

Session 1: ____/12 Session 2: ____/12 Session 3: ____/12 Criterion met ($\geq 10/12 \times 3$): []

Common Confusions to Watch For

GV vs CV “sea” titles are easy to swap under quiz pressure -- GV = yang (posterior/back), CV = yin (anterior/front). Anchor it to body position, not just memorized words.

“Confluent point” (1 point per vessel, used to open it) is not the same as “coalescent point” (any point where the vessel crosses a primary meridian along its course) -- don't conflate the two terms.

Only GV and CV have their own point sets; it's tempting to assume all 8 vessels do, since the primary 12 meridians all do -- this is the #1 structural trap for this week.

CLINICAL CASE -- APPLY IT BEFORE & AFTER

Purpose: Case reasoning bridges textbook concepts to clinical logic. Struggling before lecture is expected.

Case Vignette: Mr. Patel, 44 years old

Mr. Patel reports several weeks of difficulty falling asleep -- he feels wired and restless at bedtime, with a racing quality to his thoughts at night, but is groggy and low-energy through the day. He denies chest pain, palpitations, or overt anxiety symptoms. He mentions his ankles feel 'tight' on the outer side lately, though he isn't sure that's related. Tongue and pulse are otherwise unremarkable.

Pre-lecture: which pair of extraordinary vessels regulates sleep/wake balance, and which one would you consider calming (Yang or Yin)?

Post-lecture: revise your answer with what Dr. Zhang actually teaches about the confluent points for these vessels.

F. After-Lecture Synthesis

Before I thought...	Now I know...	Still confused about...

Update Section A confidence scores now, then file this sheet with your Week 7 Study Guide once built.